

Serena Canaan

Department of Economics

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Academic Positions:

2025–	Associate Professor, Department of Economics, Simon Fraser University
2022–	Tier 2 Canada Research Chair in Applied Microeconomics
Winter 2026	Visiting Scholar, Department of Economics, University of California San Diego
Fall 2025	Visiting Scholar, VSE, University of British Columbia
2021–2025	Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Simon Fraser University
Fall 2018	Visiting Scholar, IRLE, University of California Berkeley
2016–2022	Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, American University of Beirut

Affiliations and Professional Activities:

2025–	Associate Editor, <i>Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization</i>
2025–	Research Fellow, Institute of Labor Economics (IZA)
2024–	Associate Member, School of Public Policy, Simon Fraser University
2019–2025	Research Affiliate, Institute of Labor Economics (IZA)
2013–2016	Graduate Associate, Broom Center for Demography, UC Santa Barbara

Research Interests:

Labor Economics, Economics of Education, Family Economics

Education:

PhD Economics, University of California, Santa Barbara, 2016

M.A. Economics, University of California, Santa Barbara, 2012

M.A. Economics, American University of Beirut, 2011

B.A. Economics, Université Saint-Joseph, 2008

Publications:

“The Impact of Religious Diversity on Students’ Academic and Behavioral Outcomes,” with Antoine Deeb and Pierre Mouganie. Accepted, *Journal of Labor Economics*.

“The Long-Run Educational Benefits of High-Achieving Classrooms,” with Pierre Mouganie and Peng Zhang. *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management* 44 (4): 1347–1373, September 2025.

“Is Parental Leave Costly for Firms and Coworkers?,” with Anne Brenøe, Nikolaj Harmon and Heather Royer. *Journal of Labor Economics* 42 (4): 1135–1174, October 2024.

“Does Reducing Early School Tracking Affect Health Behaviors?” *AEA Papers and Proceedings* 114: 375–380, May 2024.

“The Impact of Advisor Gender on Female Students’ STEM Enrollment and Persistence,” with Pierre Mouganie. *Journal of Human Resources* 58 (2): 593–632, March 2023.

“Advisor Value-Added and Student Outcomes: Evidence from Randomly Assigned College Advisors,” with Antoine Deeb and Pierre Mouganie. *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy* 14 (4): 151–191, November 2022.

“Maternity Leave and Paternity Leave: Evidence on the Economic Impact of Legislative Changes in High Income Countries,” with Anne Sophie Lassen, Philip Rosenbaum and Herdis Steingrimsdottir. In *The Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Economics and Finance*, July 2022.

“Parental Leave, Household Specialization and Children’s Well-Being.” *Labour Economics* 75: 102127, April 2022.

“Does Advisor Gender Affect Women’s Persistence in Economics?,” with Pierre Mouganie. *AEA Papers and Proceedings* 111: 112–116, May 2021.

“The Long-Run Effects of Reducing Early School Tracking.” *Journal of Public Economics* 187: 104206, July 2020.

“Returns to Education Quality for Low-Skilled Students: Evidence from a Discontinuity,” with Pierre Mouganie. *Journal of Labor Economics* 36 (2): 395–436, April 2018.

Working Papers:

“Authority Figures and the Polarization of Gender Norms,” with Ali Abboud, Samuel Bazzi, Antoine Deeb and Pierre Mouganie.

“The Impact of Delaying Early School Tracking on Fertility and Marriage Outcomes.”

“The Disparate Impacts of Academic Probation,” with Stefanie Fischer, Pierre Mouganie and Geoffrey Schnorr.

Grants:

2025 “Intergroup Contact and National Integration in a Divided Society.” CEPR Reducing Conflict and Improving Performance in the Economy (ReCIPE). Role: Co-Investigator (PI: Samuel Bazzi). £24,000.

2025 “The Impact of Parental Leave on Children’s Long-Term Mental Health.” SSHRC Insight Grant. Role: PI. \$61,883.

2025 SFU Centre for Comparative Muslim Studies Major Grant. Role: PI. \$7,000.

2024 SFU FASS Kickstarter Seed Grant. Role: PI. \$13,538.

2022 “Identifying opportunities to improve the lived experiences and health of working women in the MENA: from COVID to recovery.” International Development Research Centre (IDRC) Women RISE Grant. Role: Co-PI (PI: Jocelyn Dejong). \$999,480.

2022 “Intergroup Contact and National Integration in Divided Society.” SSHRC Insight Development Grant. Role: Co-Investigator (PI: Pierre Mouganie). \$67,371.

2018 Center for Teaching and Learning SOTL Grant (AUB), with Pierre Mouganie.

2017 University Research Board Faculty Grant (AUB), with Pierre Mouganie.

2017 Short Term Faculty Development Grant (AUB).

Awards:

2025	Excellence in Reviewing Award, <i>American Economic Journal: Applied Economics</i> .
2022	Upjohn Institute Early Career Research Award (ECRA).
2014–2015	Graduate Opportunity Fellowship, University of California, Santa Barbara.
2012–2013	Research Fellow, University of California Center for Energy and Environmental Economics (UCE ³).
2012	Distinction in Macroeconomics Preliminary Examination.
2011	Best Graduate Student Paper Award, Center for Research on the Economies of the Mediterranean, Barcelona Graduate School of Economics.
2010–2011	Graduate Assistant, American University of Beirut.

Conferences and Seminars:

2026 (including scheduled):	UC San Diego; San Diego State University; SOLE Annual Meeting; WECAN Conference (Queen's University), CEA Annual Meeting.
2025:	AEA Annual Meetings (discussant); UC Riverside; Canadian Economic Association (CEA) Annual Meeting; WEAI Annual Conference; Gateway's Education, Aging, and Global Health Conference (discussant); University of British Columbia; Canadian Labour Economics Forum (CLEF) Webinar; NBER Economics of Education Fall Meeting.
2024:	AEA Annual Meeting; Gateway Education Policy Team Meeting; Western Economic Association International (WEAI) Annual Conference; AEFPP Scholars of Education in Developing Countries (EdDev) Meeting; Canadian Conference on Global Health (panel); CWEC/CFÉC Brown Bag seminar; Western Washington University.
2023:	Dalhousie University; Sciences Po Summer Workshop: Labor; University of Colorado Denver.
2022:	CESifo Venice Summer Institute Economics of Education and Equality of Opportunity; 21st IZA/SOLE Transatlantic Meeting of Labor Economists; 7th IZA Workshop on the Economics of Education; University of Johannesburg.
2021:	University of Essex; Federal Reserve Board; New York University Abu Dhabi; Nova School of Business; Católica Lisbon School of Business & Economics; Stockholm University SOFI; Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona; Simon Fraser University; Mississippi State University; Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PacDev); American Economic Association (AEA) Annual Meetings.
2020:	CESifo EffEE Conference on Econometric Evaluation of School Reforms (canceled); CESifo Venice Summer Institute Economics of Education and Equality of Opportunity (canceled); EALE SOLE AASLE World Conference.
2019:	ZEW Workshop on the Economics of Higher Education; Koç University; SOLE Annual Meeting.
2018:	UC Berkeley Labor Lunch; UC Berkeley IRLE Workshop; UC Davis; UC Santa Barbara Labor Lunch; USC CESR Brown Bag; NBER Summer Institute Children (co-author presented); 3rd Meeting of the Lebanese Econometric Study Group.
2017:	Population Association of America Meetings; SOLE Annual Meetings; 2nd IZA Junior/Senior Symposium; 1st IZA Workshop on Gender and Family Economics; 2nd Meeting of the Lebanese Econometric Study Group.

- 2016: SOLE Annual Meetings; WEAI Graduate Student Workshop; European Economic Association Annual Congress; Trans-Pacific Labor Seminar; Association for Education Finance and Policy Conference.
- 2015: 18th IZA European Summer School in Labor Economics; Southern California Conference in Applied Microeconomics; UC Santa Barbara Labor Lunch.

Teaching:

Simon Fraser University

- Econ 835 – Econometrics (Fall 2022; Fall 2024)
- Econ 280 – Introduction to Labor Economics (Spring 2023; Spring 2024)
- Econ 881 – Labor Economics (Fall 2023; Spring 2025)

American University of Beirut

Elementary Microeconomic Theory, Applied Econometrics

UC Santa Barbara

Teaching Assistant – Principles of Macroeconomics, Introduction to Econometrics, Natural Resource Economics, Intermediate Microeconomic Theory, Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory, Statistics with Economics and Business Applications.

Professional Service:

Referee for: *Journal of Political Economy, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, Journal of the European Economic Association, Review of Economics and Statistics, American Economic Review: Insights, Journal of Labor Economics, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Human Resources, Labour Economics, Demography, European Economic Review, Industrial and Labor Relations Review, Economics of Education Review, Review of Economics of the Household, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Labor Research, Economic Inquiry, Journal of Development Economics, Economics Bulletin, World Development, Journal of Population Economics, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, Economic Journal.*

- 2024– Founding member, AREena ARab Economists in Europe and North America.

University Service:

Simon Fraser University:

- 2024–2025 Member of economics department hiring committee.
- Fall 2023 Member of economics department chair search committee.
- 2023–2024 Departmental Seminar series co-organizer.
- Fall 2022 Member of economics department hiring committee.
- 2021–2022 Brown Bag Seminars co-organizer.

American University of Beirut:

- 2020 Member of the AI, Computational & Data Sciences Task Force.
- 2017–2020 Economics department library Liaison.

2017–2018 Freshman academic advisor.
2016–2017 Economics department hiring committee.

Other:

Reviewer for AUB's Center for Teaching and Learning annual conference.

Languages: English (Fluent), French (Fluent), Arabic (Native)